> As the Chief Whip has been very careful to make clear, David was not censured for his political views on the Middle East, views that are shared by many in the Liberal Democrats. . . . It is perfectly right that politicians should be able to criticise the actions of a state in the strongest of terms.

Clegg added:

> It is important to know that [David] was not asked—and would not be asked—to apologise for his political views on the situation in the Middle East.[40]

Indeed, Clegg himself led the British criticism of Israel over Operation Protective Edge and pushed for a ban on arms exports to the Jewish State.

A more likely explanation, however, is that there was genuine confusion among the Liberal Democrat Leadership about whether Ward's Holocaust inversion was antisemitic rather than merely inappropriate. It is clear that the Party has a hard time recognising antisemitism. For instance, its response to Ward's November 2013 tweet "[W]hat a shame there isn't a powerful well-funded Board of Deputies for #Roma" was to dismiss it as flattering comment, despite its invocation of the Jews-have-acquired-great-power-for-financial-reasons trope,[41] and Liberal Democrat Chief Whip Don Foster found that Ward's July 2014 tweet, "The big question is—if I lived in Gaza would I fire a rocket?—probably yes" was not motivated by antisemitism despite the fact that it appeared to endorse rocket attacks on Israeli civilians.[42] This finding also shows a lack of awareness about the fact that language can be identified as antisemitic without the need to find intent or motivation on the part of the speaker. In fact, the Liberal Democrat Party is not alone is being unable to recognise antisemitism. Many people in Britain are uncertain as to what counts as antisemitism. This is because of an overwhelming ignorance of antisemitism's pre-Holocaust history and the fact that the Holocaust conditions popular understanding of antisemitism as state-sponsored genocide.[43] Even those who do acknowledge that antisemitism can manifest itself in contemporary polemics on the Israel-Palestinian conflict have difficulty recognising it because it is frequently driven by the anti-racist left and is masked by the language of human rights.[44] There is also no broad agreement as to where the line should be drawn between legitimate criticism of Israel and antisemitism.[45] This is why the 2006 *Parliamentary Report* had recommended that the government adopt the EUMC Definition, to provide some clarity on this point.

Another possible explanation is that the Liberal Democrat Party Leadership, like many people in Britain, does not regard Jews as being in need of protection from racism. Jews are thought of as wealthy, privileged,

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